Canva Cursor — Prompt Catalog & Capabilities

A comprehensive field guide of instructions, design prompts, operations, and RAG archetypes.

Overview: Canva Cursor is an autonomous AI design editor embedded in the Canva Editor panel. It perceives your design snapshot, maps visual elements into a knowledge graph, retrieves professional design blueprints via RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation), and executes validated Canva API operations in real-time.

1. Typography & Text Styling

Canva Cursor can inspect semantic text roles (heading, subheading, body, caption) and perform selective styling or content modification.

User Prompt Example	What the Agent Does	API Operations Generated
"Make the heading red"	Locates the primary heading in the graph and updates its hex color.	`update_text_style color: #ff0000`
"Change heading text to 'Summer Flash Sale'"	Replaces wording while preserving existing font size, weight, and colors.	`update_text_content newText: 'Summer Flash Sale' preserveFormatting: true`
"Make the subtitle 24px and bold"	Targets the subtitle/tagline and updates font size and weight.	`update_text_style fontSize: 24 fontWeight: 'bold'`
"Center-align all paragraph text"	Applies center alignment to body copy regions.	`update_text_style textAlign: 'center'`
"Add a new heading 'Exclusive VIP Access' at the top"	Inserts a new text element with default 32px bold styling at top coordinates.	`add_text text: 'Exclusive VIP Access' fontSize: 32, top: 120, left: 100`
"Underline the discount price"	Identifies the price region and adds text decoration.	`update_text_style decoration: 'underline'`

2. Adding Shapes & Vector Elements

Supports creating rectangles, cards, circles, triangles, and stars with customized fill and stroke colors.

User Prompt Example	What the Agent Does	API Operations Generated
"Add a blue circle in the center"	Calculates center coordinates on the page dimensions and generates a vector SVG circle.	`add_shape shape: 'circle' color: #2563eb, size: 160×160`
"Add a card background behind the text"	Creates a solid rectangle with dimensions calculated to fit the content.	`add_shape shape: 'rectangle' color: #f1f5f9, width: 600, height: 300`

"Add a yellow star at the top right"	Generates a 5-pointed vector star shape in bright amber at upper-right margins.	`add_shape shape: 'star' color: #eab308, size: 80×80`
"Add a green triangle badge"	Creates a vector triangle element with solid green fill.	`add_shape shape: 'triangle' color: #10b981`
"Change the card fill color to dark navy #0f172a"	Finds the background shape and updates its color container.	`update_fill_color elementId: 'el-1' color: #0f172a`

3. Lines & Structural Dividers

Adds horizontal divider lines, decorative section separators, and custom-angled rule lines.

User Prompt Example	What the Agent Does	API Operations Generated
"Add a black horizontal divider below the heading"	Measures the heading's bottom coordinate and inserts a 2px horizontal line.	`add_line height: 2, width: 600 color: #000000`
"Add an orange accent bar under the title"	Inserts a short, prominent 4px accent line aligned with the title.	`add_line height: 4, width: 120 color: #f97316`
"Add a diagonal divider line tilted 45 degrees"	Inserts a line element with a 45-degree rotation property.	`add_line width: 300, rotation: 45 color: #64748b`

4. Layout, Positioning & Canvas Control

Control absolute positioning, relative shifts, element duplication, and background colors.

User Prompt Example	What the Agent Does	API Operations Generated
"Move the logo to top: 40px, left: 60px"	Relocates the target element to exact pixel coordinates.	`move_element top: 40, left: 60`
"Shift the subtitle 30px downwards"	Calculates new top = currentTop + 30 and updates the position.	`move_element top: currentTop + 30`
"Set page background to obsidian black #121214"	Updates the canvas background solid fill.	`update_background_color color: #121214`
"Duplicate the feature card with 30px offset"	Clones properties into a new element shifted down & right.	`duplicate_element offsetTop: 30, offsetLeft: 30`
"Delete the old placeholder banner"	Removes the specified element from the active page collection.	`delete_element elementId: 'el-3'`

5. Grouping & Layer Hierarchy

Manipulate the visual z-index stack or combine elements for composite editing.

User Prompt Example	What the Agent Does	API Operations Generated

"Group the icon and the heading together"	Invokes Canva group helper to link elements into a single composite group.	`group_elements elementIds: ['el-0', 'el-1']`
"Ungroup the header block"	Dissolves a composite group back into standalone elements.	`ungroup_element elementId: 'el-4'`
"Bring the heading text in front of the card"	Adjusts z-index order so the text element is layered above the shape.	`change_layer_order direction: 'after' relativeElementId: 'el-2'`
"Send the colored rectangle to the back"	Places the shape below all active page elements.	`change_layer_order direction: 'before' relativeElementId: 'el-0'`

6. RAG-Powered Aesthetic Archetypes

The built-in RAG retriever matches high-level design keywords to curated color palettes, typography scales, and mood guidelines.

User Prompt Example	What the Agent Does	API Operations Generated
"Make this look like a luxury perfume brand with gold accents"	RAG retrieves 'Luxury & Minimalist' archetype: obsidian #121214, champagne gold #d4af37, and refined margins.	`1. update_background: #121214 2. update_text_style: #d4af37 3. add_line: #c5a059`
"Style this with a modern SaaS tech aesthetic in royal blue"	RAG retrieves 'Modern Tech & SaaS Clean': slate-900 canvas, electric blue #2563eb button, and card containers.	`1. update_background: #0f172a 2. update_text_style: #ffffff 3. add_shape: #2563eb`
"Give this poster an 80s synthwave neon vibe"	RAG retrieves 'Retro 80s Synthwave': midnight purple #0d0221, neon pink #ff007f, and cyan #00f0ff.	`1. update_background: #0d0221 2. update_text_style: #ff007f 3. add_line: #00f0ff`
"Transform this into a warm organic earthy cafe menu"	RAG retrieves 'Warm Organic Bakery & Cafe': oat milk #faf7f2, terracotta #c86446, and olive accents.	`1. update_background: #faf7f2 2. update_text_style: #2c2420 3. add_shape: #c86446`
"Make this playful with modern pastel pop colors"	RAG retrieves 'Playful Modern Pop': lavender #f3e8ff, coral #ff5e7e, and sky blue accents.	`1. update_background: #f3e8ff 2. update_text_style: #1e1b4b 3. add_shape: #ff5e7e`

7. Component Blueprints & Multi-Step Compositions

RAG retrieves tested architectural formulas for complex multi-element UI components.

User Prompt Example	What the Agent Does	API Operations Generated

"Add a modern CTA card with a sign-up button in the center"	RAG retrieves CTA Blueprint: creates 600×300 container card, centered heading, supporting copy, and contrasting button.	`1. add_shape (card) 2. add_text (title) 3. add_text (subtext) 4. add_shape (button) 5. add_text (button label)`
"Add a customer testimonial quote box"	RAG retrieves Testimonial Blueprint: container card with vertical left accent bar, italicized quote, and author line.	`1. add_shape (card) 2. add_line (accent bar) 3. add_text (quote) 4. add_text (author)`
"Add a 'NEW FEATURE' pill badge right above the title"	RAG retrieves Tag Pill Blueprint: compact 140×32 rounded container with bold uppercase label text centered inside.	`1. add_shape (pill rect) 2. add_text (bold label)`

8. Pro Tips for Prompting Canva Cursor

• **Specify Relative vs Absolute:** Say *'Move 40px down'* for relative motion or *'Move to top: 100, left: 100'* for fixed placement.

• **Use Role-Based Language:** The agent understands semantic roles like *'main heading'*, *'subtitle'*, *'CTA button'*, or *'background card'*.

• **Hex Colors are Supported:** You can specify exact colors (e.g. *'#2563eb'*) or natural language (e.g. *'warm terracotta'*, *'emerald green'*).

• **Combine Actions in One Request:** You can say *'Make the heading blue, center it, and add a divider below'* — the agent generates a multi-operation plan in one step.

• **Ask for Clarification:** If multiple elements share identical names, the agent will prompt you with a clarification question rather than guessing wrongly.